

Lockups & Style-Scapes

Class II · Monday, October 5, 2026

Tonight

- Lockups: how to build them
- Style-scapes, piece by piece
- Studio: sign-offs and I-on-Is

Building Lockups

Built, Not Eyeballed

Last week: what a lockup is. Tonight: how to construct one.

- Every distance has a reason
- It holds together at any size
- You can rebuild it and spec it in your guide
- Start once your symbol and type are signed off

I. Find Your Unit

FIELDSTONE

x = cap height



Your unit. Every measurement in the system is a multiple of x.

Most often the cap height of the name. Some marks use a stroke width or a part of the symbol instead.

2. Size and Space the Symbol



Tagline: left-aligned to the name, 0.5x below it. Symbol: cap line to tagline baseline.

Everything is measured from x. Start there, then judge the result (next few slides).

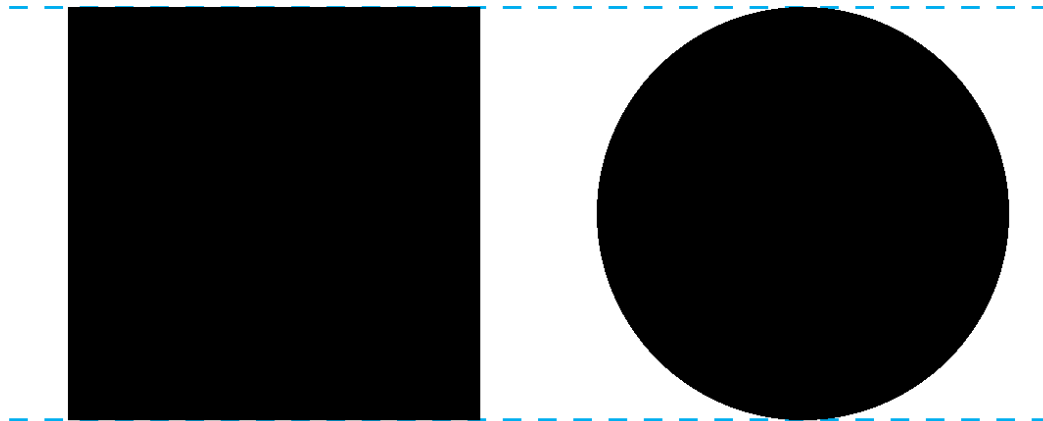
3. Build the Stacked Version



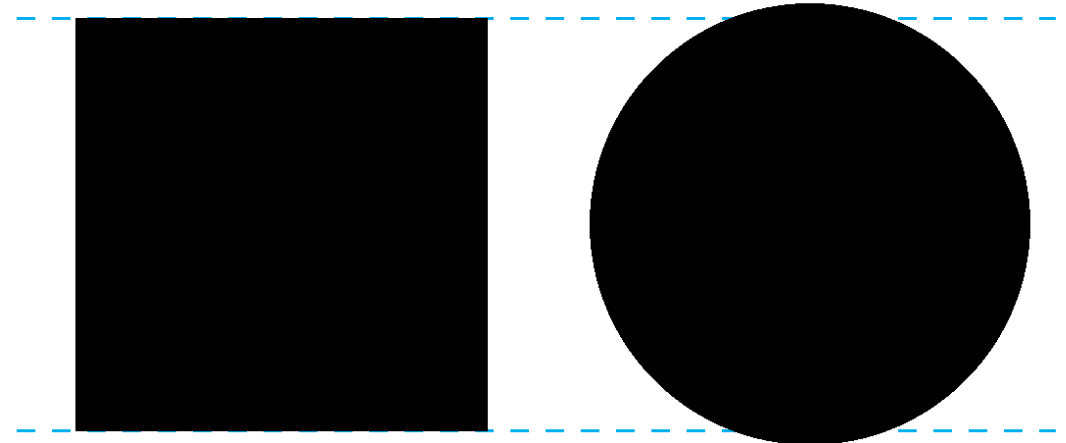
Symbol centered on the type. Check it optically, not just with Align.

Same parts, same unit. The symbol usually scales up a bit when it sits on top.

4. Trust Your Eye



Measured equal: the circle looks small



Optically equal: the circle overshoots

Round and pointed shapes need to overshoot the guide slightly to look aligned.

Grid First, Then Judgment

It's a back and forth, not a formula.

- Choose an element to build from: cap height, a stroke, part of the symbol
- Build the lockup from it
- Not working? Try a different element
- Then adjust by eye until it looks right
- Spec the final version in x, so anyone can rebuild it

5. Clear Space



Nothing else gets inside the dashed line. Measure it in x so it scales with the logo.

Usually 1x on every side. Same rule for every lockup.

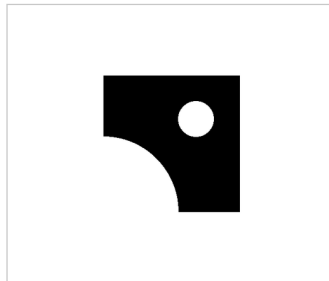
The Lockup Set



Primary: horizontal



Secondary: stacked



Symbol only



Wordmark only



Reversed

Placeholder brand, for construction only. You need each of these, in black, reversed, and color.

In Illustrator

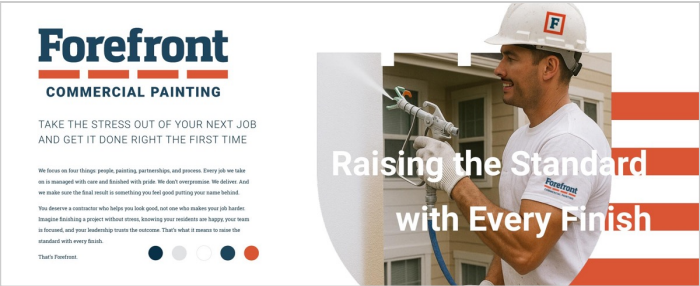
- Choose your unit first: what you'll build the grid from
- Draw an x square, keep it on its own locked layer
- Drag guides to cap height, baseline, and symbol edges
- Measure every gap with the square, not by nudging
- Each lockup on its own artboard, named consistently
- Set a minimum size: print it small and see where it breaks

Style-Scapes, Piece by Piece

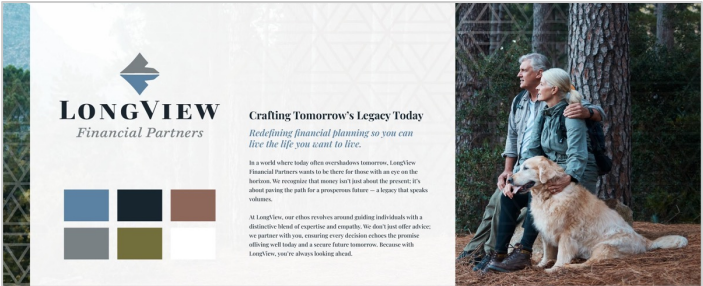
The Style-Scapes We'll Pick Apart

All KURTZ client work. Watch for these in the next slides.

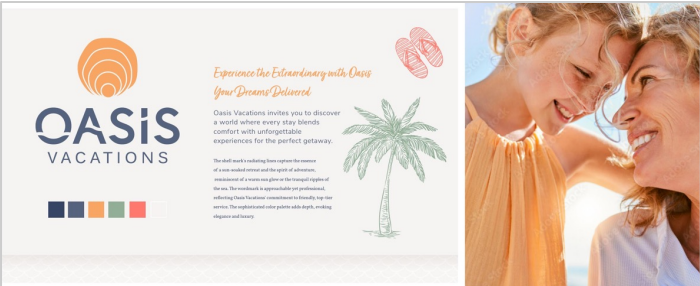
FOREFRONT



LONGVIEW



OASIS VACATIONS



MPC LAW



NEOLAX



1ST & FLOORS



The Pieces

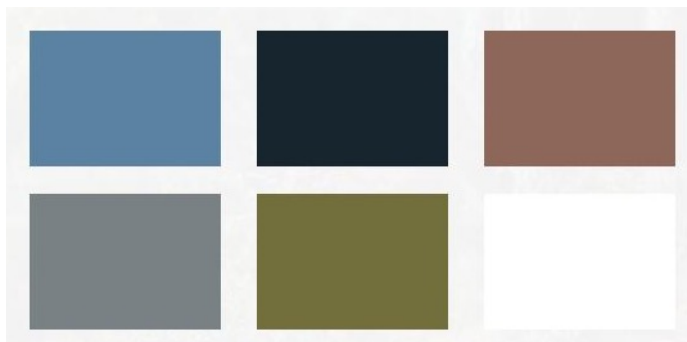
Build each piece on its own first. Then put them together.

- Color
- Type
- Photography or illustration
- Graphic devices: shapes, patterns, icons
- Voice: the headline

Color

A palette has roles: one lead, one accent, a few supports, and neutrals.

LONGVIEW



OASIS VACATIONS



MPC LAW



Building a Palette

- Start from your logo's color
- One color leads, one accent pops
- Don't forget neutrals
- Spec it all: HEX, RGB, CMYK, Pantone (start with Pantone printed swatches)
- Test contrast anywhere text sits on color, for accessibility
 - [WebAIM Contrast Checker: webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker](https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker)

Type

Headline, subhead, body: three levels, clearly different from each other.

LONGVIEW

Crafting Tomorrow's Legacy Today

Redefining financial planning so you can live the life you want to live.

In a world where today often overshadows tomorrow, LongView Financial Partners wants to be there for those with an eye on the horizon. We recognize that money isn't just about the present; it's about paving the path for a prosperous future — a legacy that speaks volumes.

At LongView, our ethos revolves around guiding individuals with a distinctive blend of expertise and empathy. We don't just offer advice; we partner with you, ensuring every decision echoes the promise of living well today and a secure future tomorrow. Because with LongView, you're always looking ahead.

MPC LAW

A NEW ERA IN CONSUMER DEFENSE

Helping Legal Underdogs Rise to Challenge the Titans

In the harsh realities of foreclosures and relentless collections, consumers often find themselves outmatched, battling debt giants with vast resources and intricate legal tactics. It's an uneven playing field, but there's a new player set to change the dynamics.

MPC Law is not your usual defender. Born from decades within the adversary's trenches, our experience brings unrivaled strategy and perspective. We don't just offer counsel; we level the field, turning the traditional defense on its head. With us, clients aren't merely defended—they're empowered to challenge and triumph over these financial giants.

NEOLAX

EMPOWERING THE NEXT GENERATION OF ATHLETES TO LEAD WITH CHARACTER & COMPETE WITH HEART.

At **NEOLAX**, we're more than just lacrosse. We build confident players and stronger teammates through our **G.R.I.T. mentality**: Gratitude, Relationships, Integrity, and Teamwork.

Whether it's your first time picking up a stick or your next step toward elite competition, our programs are designed to challenge, support, and elevate every athlete's journey.

Choosing Type

- A headline face and a body face, or one family
- Look past the logo's typeface: build a system that complements it
 - One typeface throughout can work, if it fits the brand
- Name the exact weights
- Need more styles for how the brand gets used? Add them, but only a few
- Set real copy: no Lorem Ipsum

Everything Else

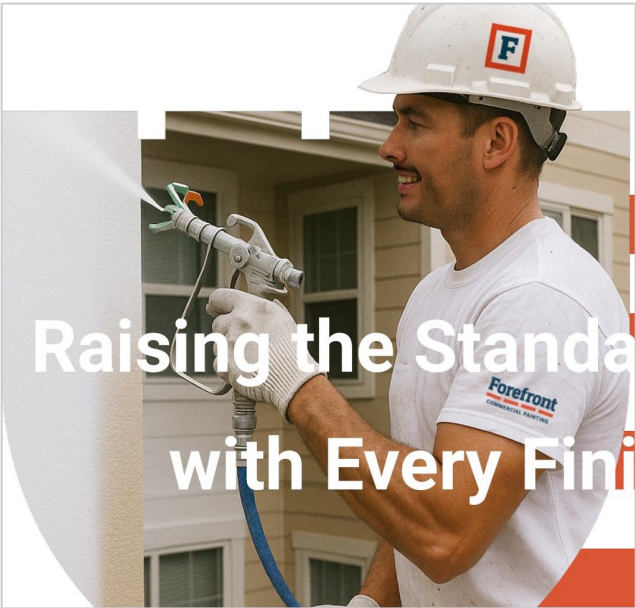
Photography, illustration, patterns, textures, icons, graphic devices.

- You don't need all of them: choose what to use, and what to leave out
- Choose what expresses your strategy: core, positioning, persona
- Photos can be full color, black and white, duotone, or another treatment
- Icons: custom-drawn to complement the logo. No clip art, no copies of the mark
- It should all feel like it came from the same place

Photography

Pick a direction: who is in it, where, what light, how close, what treatment.

FOREFRONT



The brand in the photo

LONGVIEW



The customer's life

OASIS VACATIONS



The feeling

Illustration



Oasis Vacations: one hand-drawn line style, in the palette. Optional, but if you use it, keep it consistent.

Devices Come from the Mark

Forefront: the bars under the name become a stripe pattern.

IN THE MARK



IN THE SYSTEM



Devices Come from the Mark

MPC Law: the rings of the symbol frame the photography.

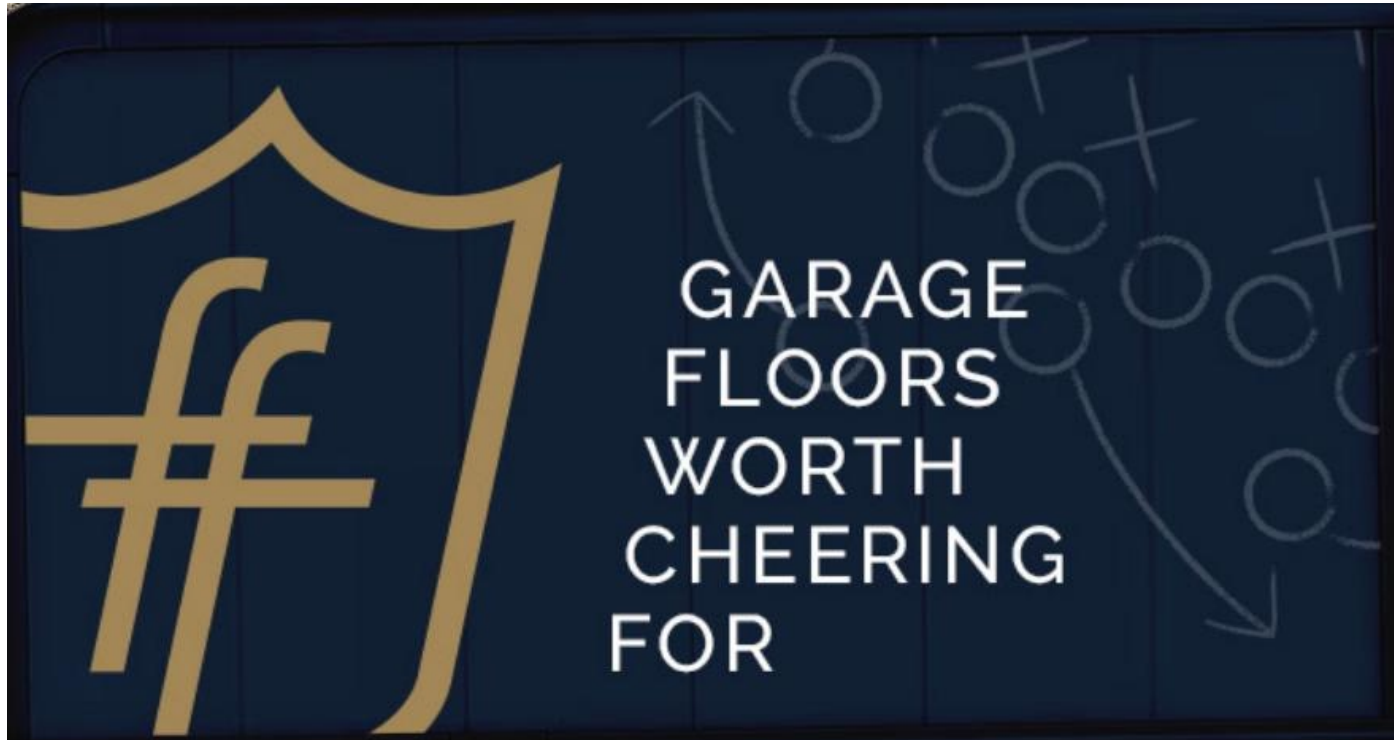
IN THE MARK



IN THE SYSTEM



Or from the Story



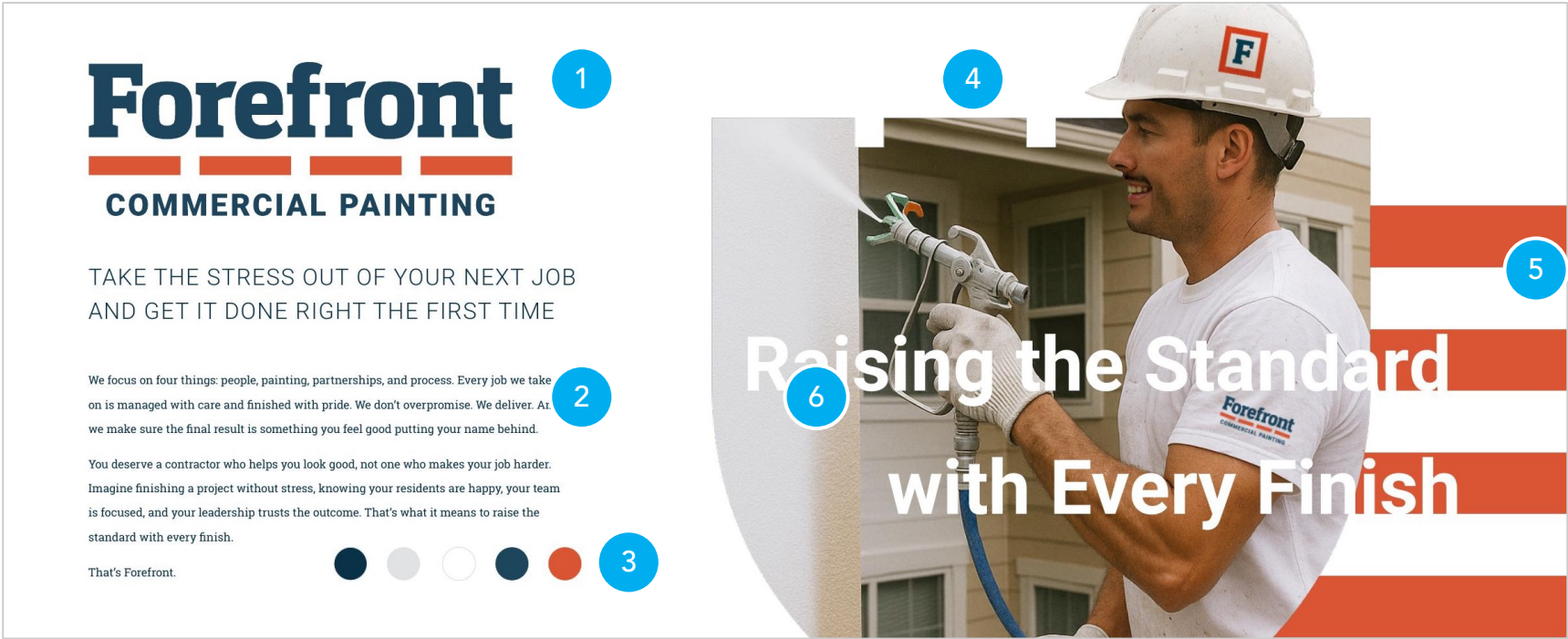
1st & Floors: a football play drawn in chalk lines, for a founder who played in the NFL.

Voice: the Headline

One line that sounds like the brand. Pull it from your research.

- “Raising the Standard with Every Finish” · Forefront
- “Garage Floors Worth Cheering For” · Ist & Floors
- “Built with G.R.I.T.” · NEOLAX
- “Crafting Tomorrow’s Legacy Today” · LongView

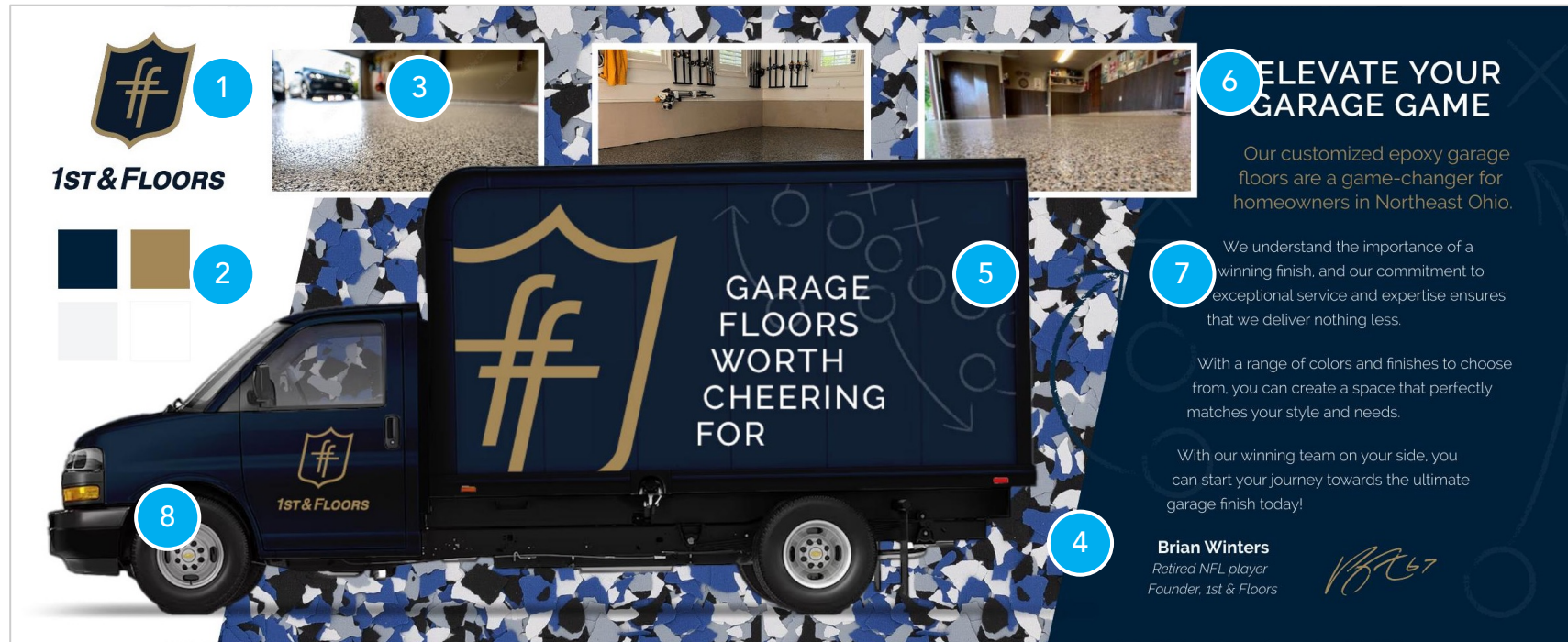
Putting It Together



- 1 Logo
- 2 Type
- 3 Color
- 4 Photography
- 5 Device
- 6 Voice

Forefront Commercial Painting. Six pieces, one board.

Putting It Together



- 1 Logo
- 2 Color
- 3 Photography
- 4 Texture
- 5 Icons
- 6 Voice
- 7 Type
- 8 Application

1st & Floors. The flake floor (the product) becomes the texture. The truck shows the system at work.

How to Build Yours

- Build the kit first: palette, type, images, device
- Sketch 2 or 3 compositions, then build the strongest
- One hero, usually the photo
- The logo gets room and prominence
- Consider hierarchy in the layout: let one or two pieces lead
- Canvas: 16:9. For the crit, print on 11x17, fit to page

Studio Time

Tonight

- Not signed off yet? That's still first. Find me
- Signed off? Build your lockups
- Then start your style-scape kit

Coming Up

- Wed Oct 7: shorter class, ends at 6:00. Studio, I-on-Is, sign-offs
- Mon Oct 12: printed crit, pinned on the wall
 - Print your own at 11x17, both directions, and bring them to class
- Wed Oct 14: System Definition due

Questions?

Then let's get to work.